



UCC Consultancy Society – Consultancy Brief

Client: O'Flynn's Gourmet Sausage Company

Project theme: Assessing the potential for a “Sausage Club” subscription model for Ireland and the UK

1. Brand background and context

O'Flynn's Gourmet Sausage Company is a Cork-based artisan food brand best known for premium sausages and a “craft butcher” proposition built around quality ingredients, flavour innovation, and a strong local reputation. The brand is well-placed to benefit from two wider consumer shifts: (1) continued growth in subscription commerce and curated food experiences, and (2) increased willingness to buy chilled food online when the value proposition is clear (quality, convenience, discovery, gifting).

Subscription “clubs” already exist in adjacent categories (meat boxes, cheese, beer, pantry staples). Market-sizing for food subscriptions specifically varies by source, but the direction is consistent: growth, increasing normalisation, and widening segment variety.

2. The challenge statement

O'Flynn's wants an evidence-based recommendation on whether a Sausage Subscription / Sausage Club is commercially viable for Ireland and the UK, and if so, what model should be launched first.

3.

The consultancy team will advise on:

- the potential market size and addressable audience (Ireland and the UK)
- the most attractive subscription formats (cadence, box size, pricing, personalisation, gifting)
- operational feasibility and cost-to-serve (especially cold-chain packaging and delivery economics)
- regulatory and trade considerations for shipping chilled meat to the UK (including SPS controls, documentation, and risk classification)
- competitor landscape and differentiation strategy
- a practical go-to-market plan and test-and-learn approach (pilot design, KPIs, and rollout triggers)

3. Project objectives

By the end of the project, the team should be able to answer:

Market and customer

- Who would buy a sausage subscription, and why (convenience, discovery, gifting, gourmet cooking, BBQ culture, Irish diaspora, etc.)?
- What is the realistic total addressable market vs serviceable available market (based on geography, delivery feasibility, and target segments)?
- What are the key barriers to adoption (price, freezer space, delivery timing, freshness concerns, dietary preferences)?

Offer design and economics

- What “Sausage Club” formats are most compelling (monthly “chef’s selection”, seasonal specials, family box, BBQ box, protein + sides, breakfast bundle, mixed meat add-ons)?
- What price points, margins, and shipping thresholds make sense (including the role of minimum order value and prepay plans)?
- What retention levers matter most (variety, exclusivity, member perks, recipes, limited editions, referral rewards)?

Operations, shipping, and compliance

- What is the most feasible cold-chain approach (insulated packaging, gel packs, time-in-transit targets, courier options, dispatch days)?
- What are the constraints for shipping to GB post-Brexit for chilled products of animal origin (documentation, pre-notification, checks, importer responsibilities), and what operating model reduces friction?
- What customer experience risks exist (late deliveries, damaged packaging, temperature excursions) and what mitigations are required?

Competitive positioning

- Who are the direct and indirect competitors in Ireland and the UK (online butchers, meat boxes, premium grocery delivery, local craft producers, meal kits)?
- What innovative subscription models in food can be adapted (tiered memberships, “drops”, limited editions, build-your-box, loyalty bundles, collaborations)?